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ORCID adoption @ Stellenbosch University

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1. Why ORCID

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- Stellenbosch University – public – research intensive
- Started a conversation with ORCID mid-2014
- Developed a project plan as one of the Library's strategic initiatives in 2015
- Signed-up with ORCID (Basic Membership) late 2014
- Approx 300 researchers already had an ORCID ID
- Project registered with Central IT Division to assist with the technical implementation
- One of first adopters in South Africa

2. ORCID in South Africa

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TENET | South Africa's Research & Education Network

South Africa ORCID Consortium since 2017

TENET South Africa

ORCID in South Africa

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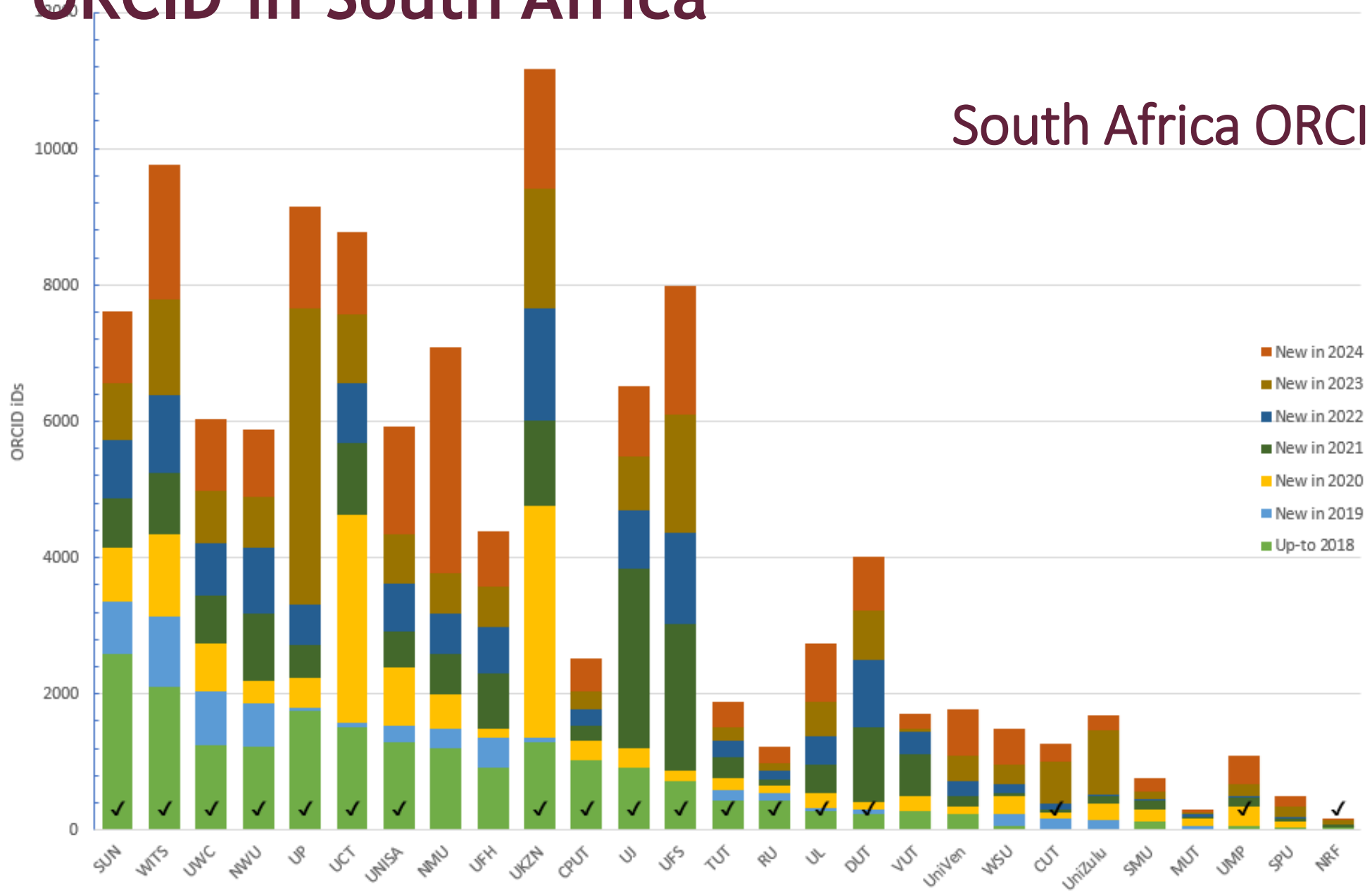
South Africa ORCID Consortium



ORCID IDs created in South Africa per university and research institution (data provided by TENET and the ORCID South Africa Consortium)

Consortium members √

Last updated August 2024
Statistics only includes those iDs created with email addresses with institution domains, e.g. sun.ac.za

3. ORCID @ Stellenbosch University

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- Integrations to enhance workflows
- Timeline
- Statistics of adoption over the years

Enhancing workflows in research systems

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Integrations enhance the visibility of research outputs and datasets:

- SU ORCID integration connects to SU identity – 2 294 SU users connected their iDs to their SU identities since 2016
  - ✓ Allows SU to update ORCID records on behalf of SU staff and students, when needed
- SUNJournals integration (Journals hosted on SU Open Journal System (OJS) platform)
  - ✓ Allows researchers to update their ORCID records with new articles published in OA journals in OJS
- SUNScholar Institutional Repository integration – 572 users connected to this integration
  - ✓ Allows researchers and students to update their ORCID records with new publication outputs
- Sympletic Elements integration (Discovery SU researcher profile portal)– 442 SU users connected
  - ✓ Allows researchers to connect their researcher profiles with their research publications – important when SU reports to the DHET / Metadata enrichment process to keep Elements researcher profiles up to date.

ORCID TIMELINE @ STELLENBOSCH UNIVERSITY

Mid 2014

Started discussions with ORCID

May 2016

Launch SU ORCID integration

Ongoing

Advocacy and promotion of integration 2016+

2024

SU integration with Sympletic Elements

2015

Strategic action; Implemen-tation team; Talk at Library Research Week, ORCID Member

2017

Joined South Africa ORCID Consortium

2023

SU integration with DSpace, Institu-tional Repository

Timeline

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Mid 2014

Started discussions with ORCID

- Started discussions with ORCID (Laurel Haak)
- Became a member of ORCID late 2014

Timeline

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2015

Strategic action; Implementation team; Talk at Library Research Week, ORCID Member

- Strategic action to implement ORCID
- Implementation Team created
- Library Research Week: Laurel Haak visited and gave a talk on ORCID
- Implementation plan and timeline for development of integration and user roll out to campus community
- Includes advocacy: News items about awareness

Timeline

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May 2016

Launch SU ORCID integration

- User roll out: Direct communication
- Advocacy and training: News items, brochures, library guide, workshops, visits to Faculty Board meetings
- Monitoring and communicating uptake to all stakeholders
- Faculty Librarians assisted with communication to faculties
- Attended and presented at ORCID Workshop

Timeline

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2017

Joined South Africa ORCID Consortium

TENET

- Joined South Africa ORCID Consortium
- Actively participates in Consortium events, such as the workshops and online coffee sessions that they offer for South African institutions to share experiences with each other

Timeline

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2023

SU integration with DSpace, Institu-tional Repository

Timeline

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2024

SU integration with Sympletic Elements

- Implemented as a researcher information system by the Division for Research Development
- Library served on the implementation team

ORCID @ Stellenbosch University

(May 2025)

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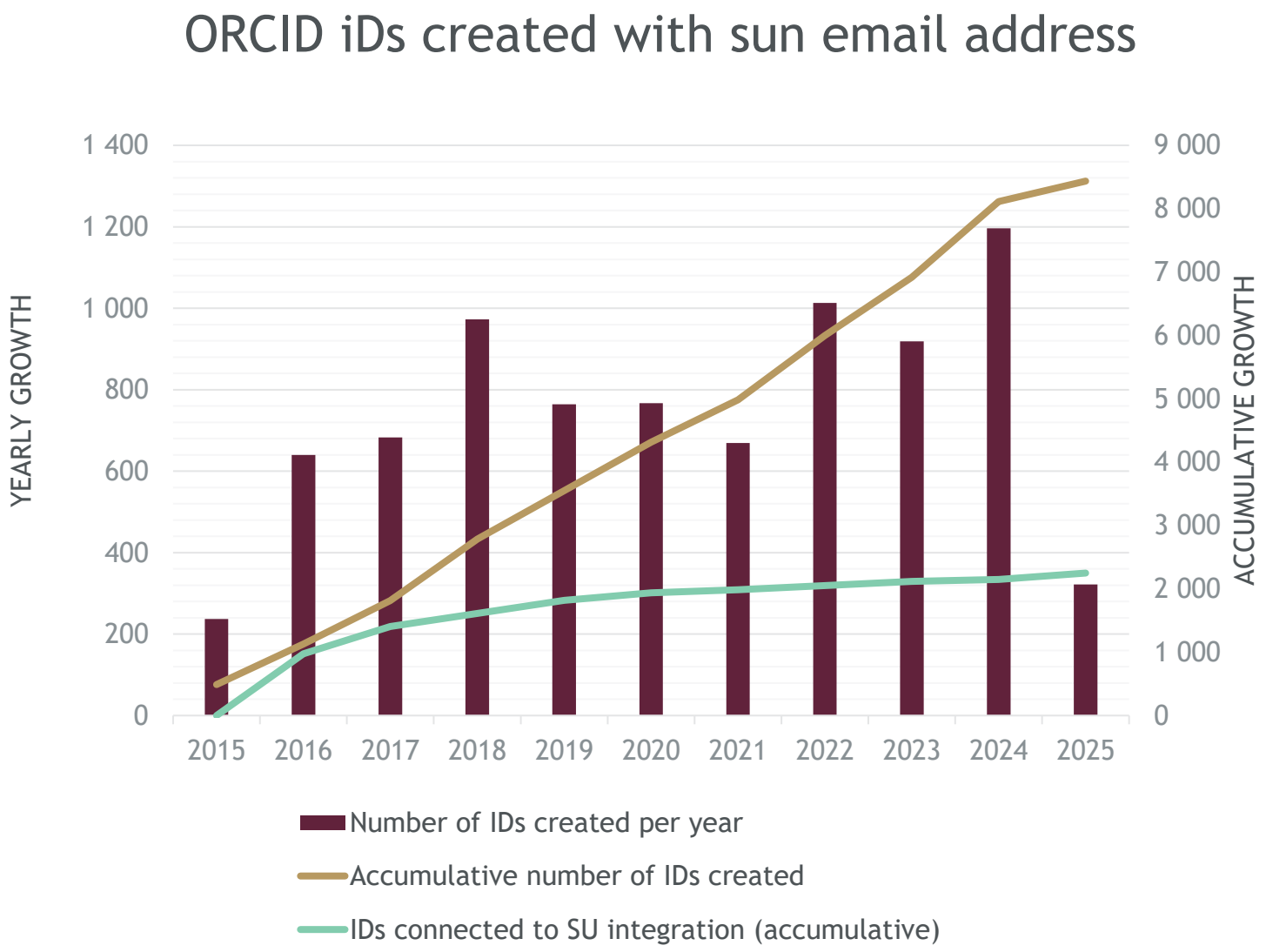
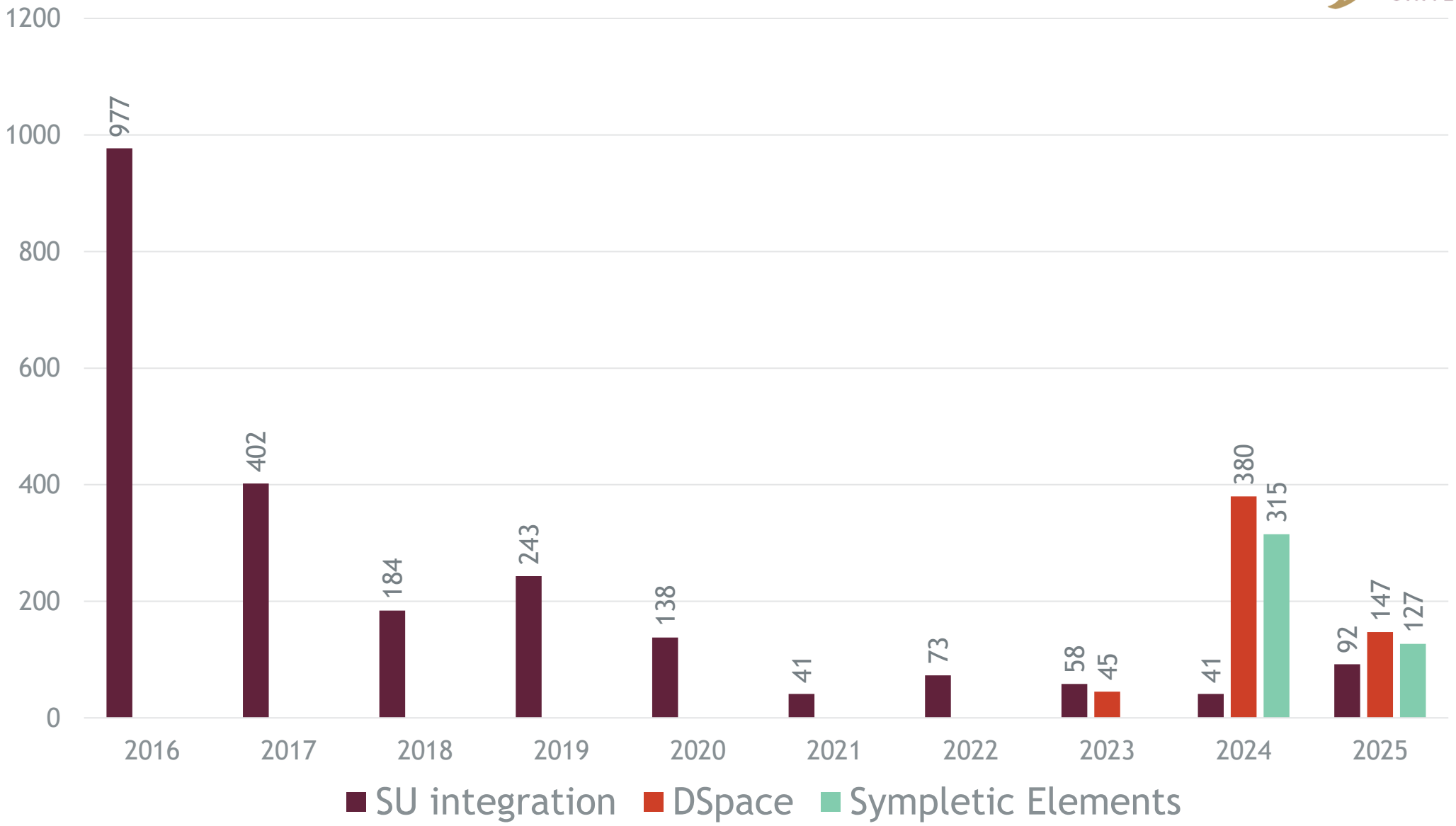
A total of about **8 435** Stellenbosch University staff and students using a sun.ac.za e-mail address have registered ORCID iDs up to December 2024.

Of these, **2 249** had connected their IDs to their SU identities through the University's integration with ORCID.



Growth of connected users in ORCID integrations at SU



4. Advocacy and Training

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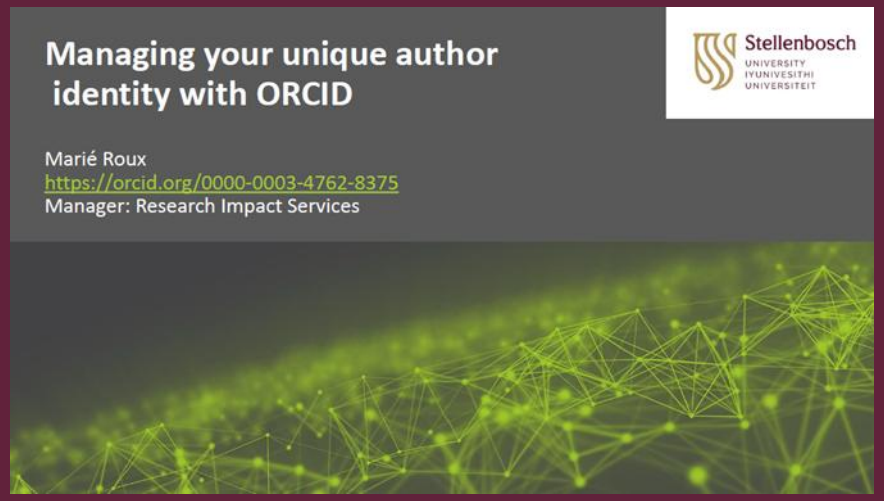
- Early days: Brochures, Information sheets, news items, e-mail marketing
- Nowadays: Not many printed items, blog posts, Library Research News newsletter, other SU news items, social media, yearly Research Orientation Days organised by Division for Research Development
- Training for groups / departments or faculties on request
- One-on-one training and assistance where needed
- Workshop presented each semester as part of the #SmartResearcher workshop series: **Managing your unique author identity with ORCID**
- Yearly workshops requested by Postdoctoral Office



4. Advocacy examples

- Social media, Research Orientation Days

Brochure

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ORCID
Connecting Research and Researchers

What is Open Researcher and Contributor ID (ORCID)

- ✓ Unique, persistent identifier for researchers and scholars
- ✓ Non-profit organization supporting linkages between systems

Benefits to you?

- ✓ Improves discoverability
- ✓ Connects your work
- ✓ Eliminates name ambiguity
- ✓ Stays with you throughout your career

Get your free ORCID iD and connect it to SU

https://midtier.sun.ac.za/user-identity-manage

Use your ORCID iD!

- ✓ Manuscript submission
- ✓ Grant applications
- ✓ Professional society membership
- ✓ Link with other identifiers & profiles
- ✓ Display on your CV, web page, and more
- ✓ Connect your ORCID iD with your institutional repository

Distinguish yourself in three easy steps:

1 REGISTER

Get your unique ORCID identifier Registration takes 30 seconds. http://orcid.org

2 ADD YOUR WORK

Enhance your ORCID record with your professional information and link to your other identifiers (such as Scopus or ResearcherID or LinkedIn).

3 USE YOUR ORCID iD

Include your ORCID identifier on your webpage, when you submit publications, apply for grants, and in any research workflow to ensure you get credit for your work.

Information sheet

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ORCID in 3 steps

1. Create your ORCID iD,
2. Connect it to your SU identity and
3. Populate it with your biography and works

Open Researcher and Contributor iD (ORCID) provides you with a unique and persistent personal identifier that connects you and your research activities throughout your career.

STEP 1 & 2:
Create and connect your ORCID iD

- Follow the "Create or connect your ORCID iD" link from the Library guide:

http://libguides.sun.ac.za/ORCID

Create or Connect your ORCID iD

- After prompted to sign in on My.Sun you will be directed to the page "Manage your Researcher Identifiers"
- Click on the "Connect" button next to ORCID
- Create your iD or sign in and "Authorize"

This will allow you to connect your iD to SU, it will also allow SU to store an access token to your iD for future use in other integrations with ORCID (which will be developed over time).

It is preferable to use your sun.ac.za e-mail address when creating your iD

If you already have an ORCID iD, please sign in on this page and click on "Authorize".

WHY?

- Your lifelong digital name, eliminates name ambiguity
- Free to register, easy to use
- Enter once and reuse often
- You are in control of your privacy settings
- Enables discoverability and recognition
- Embedded in the systems you use (embeddedness growing rapidly)
- Increasingly being required by funders and publishers (NRF is member of ORCID, busy with integration development)
- National roll-outs are taking place (UK, Italy, Australia)
- CrossRef auto-update ORCID records

STEP 3:
Populate your ORCID iD with your biography and works

Update your personal information

Click on the *Account settings* tab at the top of the screen to edit your settings, e.g. add or alter your e-mail address, change password, etc.

In *My ORCID record* you can update your personal information, add education and employment information.

Add your publications

Click on *Import works* to connect to a number of databases, e.g. ResearcherID (Web of Science), Scopus, CrossRef, etc.

Click on the title of the database you wish to import from and click *Authorise*. Follow the instructions for each wizard.

Click on *Add work manually* if you have to add any other publications that are not captured in these linked databases.

Import your work from Google Scholar Citation Profile

To import your publications from your Google Scholar Citation Profile, you will need to first export the publications list from Google Scholar in BibTeX format.

From your Google Scholar Citation profile page, select all your publications, then click Export to a BibTeX file. Once this is saved, login to your ORCID profile and under Works, select Add Works > Import

ORCID's auto-update functionality with Crossref / DataCite is proof that they are taking big steps to provide tools to automate the connection between researchers and their publications/works.

The best way to keep in touch with ORCID activities and developments is by checking the News section of their website for periodic updates or by following their Twitter account.

https://twitter.com/ORCID_Org

http://orcid.org

Enquiries and help:

- Library Guide: ORCID and other research or identifiers, http://libguides.sun.ac.za/ORCID
- Your Faculty Librarian
- Research Commons staff

Advocacy Examples

- Email Marketing campaigs
  - SU Infographic embedded in direct e-mail communication to staff and students, distributed by Faculty Librarians (2019/2022)

Advocacy examples

- Library Research News blog
- Library Research News newsletter distributed to 15 000+ staff and postgraduate students

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Library Research News blog posts

Tips to optimise your ORCID record

APRIL 30, 2025 / MARIÉ ROUX / 0 COMMENTS / EDIT

ORCID is a unique, persistent identifier that researchers can use throughout their careers as they engage in research, scholarship, and innovation. It offers several benefits, including enhancing the visibility and potential impact of a researcher's work and helping to distinguish between individuals with similar names through effective name disambiguation. Stellenbosch University has been a member of ORCID since 2015. For the University to fully realise the benefits of this affiliation, it is essential that researchers actively maintain their ORCID records and link them to the institution.

5. Community Outreach

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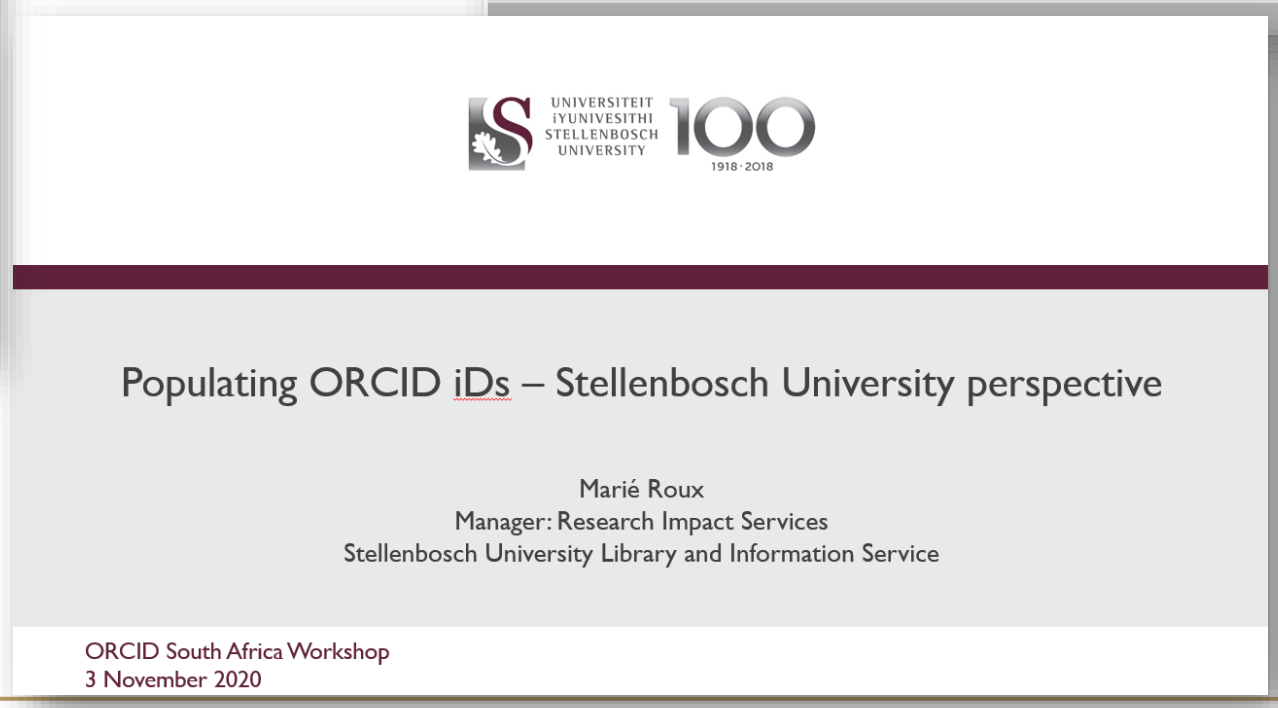
- Workshops: presented at three ORCID South Africa workshops over 10 year period
- Poster at Open Repositories Conference (2020)
- EIFL webinar (2021)

Community outreach
Presentations at ORCID workshops



Community outreach
Online Poster: Open Repositories Conference 2020

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STELLENBOSCH UNIVERSITY'S ORCID INTEGRATION: THE HIGHS AND THE LOWS

MARIÉ ROUX

MANAGER: RESEARCH IMPACT SERVICES

ORCID
Connecting Research and Researchers

Community Outreach

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- WEBINAR: ORCID AND REPOSITORY INTEGRATIONS (EIFL) – 2021
- EIFL (Electronic Information for Libraries) – Organiser: Iryna Kuchma

Gabriela Mejias (ORCID's Engagement Manager), **Daryl Grenz** (Digital Repository Lead, King Abdullah University of Science and Technology), **Marié Roux** (Research Impact Services Manager, Library and Information Service, Stellenbosch University Library) and **Roberto Barbera** (University of Catania, NADRE - National Academic Digital Repository of Ethiopia and SORER - The Somali Research and Education Repository) discuss ORCID and repository integrations (DSpace and Invenio).

5. Achievements

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- Library taking the lead
- Growth of numbers connected to the integrations
- Awareness and action on campus
- Community participation

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Thank you
Enkosi
Dankie

Photo by Stefan Els